

The Ultimate Home Jukebox

desirable. The situation worsens when the available hardware is so ancient that finding backward compatible software, let alone using the latest codec, becomes a painstaking exercise.

GeeX World

GeeXboX, the stand-alone multimedia operating system, comes to the rescue. The mini jukebox can boot from a live CD or be installed to your hard disk. The space required for the install and the characteristic speed of execution are first to take your breath away. At under 7 MB, the lightweight Linux based distribution is ideal for small hard drives so that more space is available for the music.

Since it uses the popular Linux based ALSA packages and the versatile MPlayer itself, files sporting diverse formats are easily handled. If your CDRom/RW has stood the tests of time, then you can enjoy audio and video CDs too. Again, for newer hardware, there is some great news—the DVD playback part of GeeXboX comes equipped with a DVD menu unlike most other peers.

In most cases, TV tuner cards are auto-detected, though some hacking may be required to get Indian channels. What comes as a surprise is the corresponding remote controlled menu. It eliminates the need of a keyboard. For instance, you can use the remote supplied with your TV tuner card to navigate

Get that one last dance out of your old PC

Dhruv Mohindra

If you find yourself staring pitifully at a pile of metal, manufactured somewhere around (or even much later) the dawn of the new millennium, then read on. The yellow computer case and the grandfather monitor that have been envying your relatively newer possessions can be used for more than simple museum decoration—you can make it your very own jukebox, and with no additional expenses at that.

Isn't Winamp good enough?

Yes and no. Any jukebox software that runs over an external Operating System uses its various services. The responsibility of detecting and identifying the hardware lies solely with the OS and not the jukebox software. Thus compatibility of such software across various PC configurations is never an issue. However, the overhead of running the mammoth <insert your favorite OS's name here> is simply not



Loading the GeeXboX multimedia operating system

Illustration Pravin Warhokar